



MOROS

PLAYER MANUAL

An adventure game of cards, tension, and growing mastery

From the river forests of the north to the southern desert and the volcanic coast at the world's edge, the lands between two kingdoms are crossed by traders, soldiers, and people who simply want a road home. You are about to make your way across them.

WELCOME TO MOROS

In Moros, a small group of players builds heroes from eight core statistics — strength, speed, wit, and will among them — shaping each through a history of racial powers, backgrounds, and skills taught by Masters. Together they face scenarios: encounters and challenges resolved not by dice, but by a shared deck of cards drawn fresh each round. Each player draws two and commits one as their action; the statistics a card shows determine what powers it, and a character's mastery determines how hard those powers land.

As players work together — passing cards, aiding one another, pushing the Tension higher — the world responds in kind. When Tension breaks past five, the scene itself becomes hostile, weaving complications into every hand dealt. Between scenarios, characters grow: experience spent on new specializations, forged contacts, and deeper mastery of hard-won powers shapes who a hero will become on the next venture into a world that does not give ground easily.

This manual is everything a player needs to make a character and play the game. You will find the eight statistics that shape what a character can do, the seventeen races they can be born into, the backgrounds and powers that turn a body and a history into a hero, and the cards that resolve every test the world puts in front of them.

Read it from end to end the first time. After that, the *Statistics*, *Powers*, and *Backgrounds* sections work as quick reference at the table.

THE WORLD — AT A GLANCE

Moros is a continent shaped by two kingdoms, an inland trade road, and the spaces between them. What follows is the surface a stranger sees on first arrival.

Allondo is the older kingdom, holding the central river-valley, the agricultural belt, and the capital at Scarlet Vale. Its court still trains princes for war and its border watch still names the trees on its northern edge.

Brumal is its southern neighbour — a colder, harder kingdom whose southern villages have been thinning for a generation as a desert presses up from below. Its capital is Cliffside Hold, on the coast.

The trade road runs from Linar Harbour on the east coast inland through Elmsfield and beyond — the thread that ties the kingdoms to the harbours, the desert cities, and the river forests.

The southern desert is the frontier between known country and the shifting lands beyond. Fata Morgana, the oasis city, holds the deep south by reputation; Gap City watches the mountains beyond.

The river forest of the north is great enough that a city sits on rafts in its rivers — Raft City — and its trade reaches the harbours by routes only a few merchant groups know.

The volcanic coast at the world's edge holds World Edge, the mining city, and the small mining villages at Rosepond and beyond. Iron from these forges supplies both kingdoms.

Beyond these regions are wilder places, hazards, and the stories travellers carry home from them. *The DM will introduce these as the campaign reaches them.*

PLACES OF ORIGIN

Every character starts from one of these. The character's place shapes who they know, who knows them, and what the road back to home would feel like.



Blackwood freehold

Agricultural town in Allondo.



Bockthicket

Mining town of Brumal.



Chatter Creek

Northern border town of Allondo.



Clear water

Mining town of Allondo.



Cliffside hold

Capital of Brumal.



Elmsfield

Border town around a huge tree.



Fata morgana

Oasis city in the southern desert.



Gap city

Hanging city towards the shifting lands.



Lastwater

Travel stop to the south.



Linar harbour

Small but independent harbour town.



Raft city

On the river through the great forest.



Rakeville

The next village towards Allondo.



Rosepond

Mining village near world edge.



Salmonswell

Independent small upriver city; salmon runs at the Upwelling.



Scarlet vale

Capital of Allondo.



Steadington

Village in Brumal overtaken by the desert.



World edge

Mining city near the ocean.

FACES YOU'LL MEET

A few public figures every party in Moros will cross paths with — landmarks of the road, not secrets of the campaign.



INNKEEPER BRIDGET

Badger; runs the Inn at the centre of Elmsfield's great ironwood tree. The Inn keeps moving around her; locals at their tables, merchants at the trader's corner, her children running plates. She knows roughly who has come through her door and roughly what they were carrying. A traveller's first proper meal in Elmsfield is at her bar.

The DM will introduce more figures as the campaign reaches them; the manual stops here so the rest land in play, not on this page.

MAKING A CHARACTER

A character is built from six choices, taken in order. The order is the character's life so far — where they grew up, what they trained in, what they leaned into.

Choose a name, a gender, and a place of origin. Any of the seventeen places listed above. The place gives no mechanical bonus; it gives the character a home.

Choose a race. This determines the seven powers your character can ever take.

Take six progression steps in order. Each step is one of three kinds — a *background* (a life history), a *power* (a racial ability), or a *specialization* (a trained skill).

The first six progression steps cost nothing. From the seventh step onward, advancement costs experience points (XP), earned through play.

CADENCE RULES

No two backgrounds in a row, and no two specializations in a row. A power must separate them. Powers themselves can repeat — each repetition is a deeper mastery of the same power.

A specialization can only be taken once a background that unlocks it has been taken. A specialization's level can never exceed the combined level of all backgrounds that unlock it.

No single statistic can be raised more than three times in the first six progressions. Stats above 4 must be earned through XP-paid advancement after creation.

A power must be on your race's list of seven. Each race has its own list; consult the *Races* section.

WHAT EACH STEP DOES

Background — adds 1 to one of two linked statistics, unlocks 2 item slots (+1 per additional level), and unlocks specific specializations.

Power — adds 1 to one of two linked statistics, gives the character a card they can play in scenarios, and reaches a new mastery level (deeper specials at higher mastery).

Specialization — adds 1 to its governing statistic and unlocks special actions tied to that statistic.

THE EIGHT STATISTICS

Every test in the game touches one or two of these. They are the spine of every character.

Each statistic has an associated *action* — the broad way it expresses itself in play — and a description of what it covers in different kinds of scenes.

Stats start at 1 and can be raised through progression. A character at 4 in a stat is exceptional; a character at 6 is once-in-a-generation.

CHARISMA (CHAR) — INSPIRE

The force of personality that moves people. A high-Charisma character leads, persuades, and holds a group together under pressure — not merely through charm, but through the conviction that makes others listen and believe.

Combat: A well-timed word can redirect allies, break enemy morale, or turn the tide without raising a weapon.

Hourly: Build trust and lasting bonds; friendships forged here open doors later.

Social: Command a room with performance, fast-talk past suspicion, or play a convincing role.

Travel: Keep spirits high over long miles; morale is a resource, and Charisma spends it wisely.

Defocus: Lose yourself in mindless, meticulous work — cleaning thoroughly empties the mind.

Refocus: Trade stories and small talk; connection sharpens the will to charm.

DEXTERITY (DEX) — ACTION

Precision of body — the discipline that places force exactly where it needs to go. Throwing, catching, climbing, sneaking, riding: Dexterity governs every action that demands fine control over raw strength.

Combat: Block incoming blows, deflect thrown objects, and land strikes where accuracy matters more than power.

Hourly: Tackle climbs, tight squeezes, and physical challenges that demand balance and coordination.

Social: Move unseen through a crowd, juggle to impress, or vanish from sight when things go wrong.

Travel: Stay in the saddle when the terrain fights back and keep pace without straining.

Defocus: A quiet nap — the body goes still and the reflexes reset.

Refocus: Free climbing without a rope demands total presence; the wall sharpens the mind.

ENDURANCE (ENDU) — RESIST

The body's willingness to keep going. Every blow taken, every sleepless night, every league beyond exhaustion — Endurance is the wall between a character and collapse. It sets how much they can carry and how much punishment they can absorb before they stop.

Combat: Absorb damage that would drop a lesser character; Endurance measures how long you remain standing.

Hourly: Brave the cold, the heat, hunger, and other punishing conditions without faltering.

Social: Hold the room's attention through sheer physical presence and gravity.

Travel: Cover ground without complaint; a high-Endurance character sets the group's pace.

Defocus: Sleep deeply and completely — full rest clears the strain.

Refocus: Long hours in the saddle; the body grows accustomed to sustained effort.

HANDINESS (HAND) — TRICK

The practical intelligence of the hands. Crafting, repairing, disarming, sleight of hand — Handiness turns materials into solutions. A handy character is never truly without tools, because they can make something useful out of almost anything.

Combat: Strip a weapon from an opponent's grip with technique rather than brute force.

Hourly: Craft, repair, and improvise — given time and materials, a handy character can build nearly anything.

Social: Palm objects, swap items unseen, or produce something unexpected at exactly the right moment.

Travel: Keep equipment functional; a well-maintained kit prevents disasters on the road.

Defocus: Let the hands move without the mind — sketching empties the head.

Refocus: Cooking a meal or running through maintenance rituals reconnects focus to purpose.

MIGHT (MIGHT) — BATTLE

The raw authority of physical force. Close combat, breaking things down, hauling heavy loads, and radiating a presence that makes threats credible — Might is not simply strength, it is the body's capacity to impose its will on the world.

Combat: Strike hard in close quarters; every swing carries the full weight of the character behind it.

Hourly: Force open doors, move obstacles, break through barriers — when the direct path is blocked, Might clears it.

Social: Loom, threaten, and let the body's power speak before the mouth does.

Travel: Shoulder heavy loads and keep moving; Might determines how much the group can haul.

Defocus: A calm, unhurried walk — let the muscles unwind and the tension drain.

Refocus: Haul something genuinely heavy; the body and mind re-align under real resistance.

PERCEPTION (PERC) — SPOT

The gift of noticing — and the discipline of using what you notice. Ranged attacks, detecting deception, reading a scene before it turns hostile, tracking quarry across hard ground: Perception turns raw information into decisive advantage before others realize something is there.

Combat: Land ranged attacks with precision and read the field to find weaknesses before striking.

Hourly: Search thoroughly — hidden passages, concealed items, and overlooked details fall to a careful eye.

Social: Detect lies, read intent, and notice the things people are trying very hard not to show.

Travel: Scout ahead, read the terrain, and warn the group before trouble arrives.

Defocus: Deliberately look at nothing; the senses need rest as much as the body.

Refocus: Stand lookout or follow a trail; active, purposeful attention resets the mind.

SPEED (SPEED) — MOVE

The freedom to be somewhere else. Dodging, sprinting, closing distance or opening it: Speed determines who acts first, who escapes, and who arrives when it still matters. In a fight, a fast character controls the space; on the road, they define how far the group travels.

Combat: Stay ahead of incoming attacks; a fast character is where the blow was, not where it lands.

Hourly: Cover ground quickly when time is against you — running beats every other option.

Social: Slip through a crowd, cross a room, or leave before a conversation turns dangerous.

Travel: Set a fast pace and reach the destination before circumstances can change.

Defocus: Hang around without purpose — the body recovers from all that motion.

Refocus: A steady jog clears the head and primes the legs for what comes next.

WILLPOWER (WILL) — FOCUS

The architecture of intent — the stat that keeps a character themselves when everything tries to unmake them. Resisting fear, sustaining a power's focus, aiming under chaos, holding the mind intact against the supernatural: Willpower is the foundation the other statistics rest on when circumstances turn hostile.

Combat: Resist fear effects, hold your nerve, and aim with precision when the situation demands mental composure.

Hourly: Maintain concentration on a task despite distraction, pain, or the pressure to give up.

Social: See through influence and manipulation; a strong will is the hardest wall to climb.

Travel: Keep a clear head over long journeys; mental clarity prevents costly mistakes in unfamiliar territory.

Defocus: Lose yourself in a book — the mind quiets when it follows someone else's thoughts.

Refocus: Work through a complex puzzle; the mind sharpens itself against a real challenge.

THE SEVENTEEN RACES

Moros's people are all demi-human — animal-folk and human alike share the same shape of life, with their own clans, traditions, and inherited powers.

Each race has a list of seven powers. A character can only ever learn powers from their own race's list. The list is a statement about what the race *is* — Badgers dig and craft; Owls hunt and stand watch; Finches sing and fly; Humans are diplomats and adapters.

BADGERS

Sturdy diggers and craftspeople.

Powers: Digging, Ingenuity, Portage, Claw, Camp, Fur, Scrounger

BATS

Nocturnal flyers with keen hearing.

Powers: Flight, Scrounger, Blood, Claw, Night, Scolding, Hearing

BEAVERS

Industrious builders and swimmers.

Powers: Ingenuity, Hunter, Jaws, Swimmer, Camp, Fur, Nimble

CATS

Graceful hunters with nine lives.

Powers: Hunter, Nimble, Relaxed, Climber, Blood, Claw, Night

CROWS

Clever and adaptable scavengers.

Powers: Lookout, Ingenuity, Adaptation, Balance, Scolding, Flight, Night

FINCHES

Social songbirds with political savvy.

Powers: Musical, Clan, Balance, Hearing, Politics, Flight, Scolding

FOXES

Cunning travelers and tricksters.

Powers: Adaptation, Climber, Musical, Labyrinth, Sly, Nimble, Travels

HUMANS

Versatile and diplomatic survivors.

Powers: Adaptation, Ingenuity, Balance, Portage, Politics, Sly, Lookout

OTTERS

Playful swimmers and nimble scouts.

Powers: Hunter, Swimmer, Fur, Nimble, Scurry, Sly, Lookout

OWLS

Silent hunters with commanding presence.

Powers: Claw, Clan, Hunter, Lookout, Charge, Flight, Scolding

BOAR FOLK

Resilient diggers with thick hides.

Powers: Digging, Hide, Camp, Smell, Sleeper, Charge, Scolding

RABBITS

Alert burrowers quick to find shelter.

Powers: Camp, Labyrinth, Scrounger, Hearing, Sleeper, Fur, Digging

RACCOONS

Resourceful scavengers and shapeshifters.

Powers: Scurry, Camp, Relaxed, Sly, Scrounger, Clan, Control

RAT FOLK

Adaptable urban survivors in tight-knit clans.

Powers: Clan, Scurry, Climber, Sleeper, Smell, Scrounger, Control

BULL FOLK

Strong wanderers with enduring calm.

Powers: Portage, Swimmer, Charge, Labyrinth, Relaxed, Hide, Travels

WOLF FOLK

Pack hunters with keen senses.

Powers: Jaws, Travels, Control, Hide, Clan, Smell, Hearing

MOUSE FOLK

Small careful folk in close-knit clans; line-keepers, precision crafters, and quiet diplomats.

Powers: Clan, Hearing, Scurry, Ingenuity, Sly, Politics, Sleeper



MOUSE FOLK

A Mouse-folk traveller on the trade road

POWERS

Thirty-seven powers are available across the seventeen races. Each power has two linked statistics, a special card-effect, and a description.

Mastery — each power can be learned multiple times. Mastery 1 is the basic form; mastery 2 and 3 add deeper effects called out in this section.

Overwhelmed — every power has a state where it slips from the player's control. A power Overwhelms when used two turns in a row without a stat-matching card, when one of its linked statistics is at 0, or when the environment makes it impossible. The full rule is in the *Card System* section.

ADAPTATION (WILL · CHAR) SHADOW STEP

Move around increasingly undetected.

BALANCE (DEX · WILL) TUMBLE

Moving erratically, eventually impossible to hit.

BLOOD (WILL · MIGHT) REGENERATE

Borrow the life energy from someone else.

CAMP (CHAR · ENDU) SHIELDING

Find a safe place to recuperate.

CHARGE (SPEED · MIGHT) PRONE

Increasingly impossible to be stopped.

CLAN (CHAR · WILL) SHELTER

Ensures aid when encountering kindred people.

CLAW (MIGHT · DEX) SNEAK

Increased damage when attacking unnoticed.

CLIMBER (DEX · MIGHT) REACH

Scale walls and trees.

CONTROL (ENDU · PERC) SHAPE

Modify your form, possibly stronger and more enduring.

DIGGING (ENDU · MIGHT) BREACHING

Dig through the earth at an increasing speed.

DRUID (WILL · MIGHT) NATURE

Let nature come to your aid.

FLIGHT (SPEED · DEX) FLYING

At first a glide, but eventually fully free flight.

FUR (ENDU · DEX) DEFENSE

Increased protection from harm including the elements.

HEARING (PERC · CHAR) INFORMATION

Increased sensitivity to sound.

HIDE (ENDU · WILL) ARMOR

Protection from cutting and stabbing.

HUNTER (PERC · HAND) CATCHING

Tracking and snaring prey.

INGENUITY (HAND · WILL) IMPROVISE

The uncanny ability to create anything from scraps.

JAWS (MIGHT · ENDU) GRAB

Increased damage from biting.

LABYRINTH (PERC · WILL) NAVIGATE

Navigate and create mazes.

LOOKOUT (PERC · ENDU) GUARDING

Notice the tiniest details.

MAGIC (WILL · HAND) ELEMENTAL

Bend the existing elements to your will.

MUSICAL (CHAR · DEX) ATMOSPHERE

Influence the mood when people pay attention.

NIGHT (PERC · DEX) STALK

See clearly but also blend with shadows.

NIMBLE (SPEED · DEX) DASH

Get a boost from moving on all fours.

POLITICS (CHAR · PERC) COMMON CAUSE

Know how to reach common ground.

PORTAGE (ENDU · HAND) TRAVEL

Haul goods with apparent ease.

RELAXED (ENDU · CHAR) UNWIND

Radiate calm to the people around.

RELIGION (CHAR · WILL) BLESS

Grant others physical and mental boosts.

SCOLDING (MIGHT · WILL) TAUNT

Grab the attention of enemies.

SCROUNGER (HAND · PERC) PROVISIONS

Find useful supplies in unlikely places.

SCURRY (DEX · PERC) SNEAKING

Burst of speed and being hard to spot.

SHAMANIC (WILL · ENDU) BINDING

Interact with the spirits around you.

SLEEPER (WILL · ENDU) RECOVER

Recover in almost any circumstance.

SLY (CHAR · HAND) TRICK

Able to trick those around you.

SMELL (PERC · ENDU) TRACKING

Follow tracks, recognize people.

SWIMMER (DEX · ENDU) SURVIVAL

Open water is nothing to be scared of.

TRAVELS (SPEED · PERC) SCOUTING

Instantly be familiar in unknown places.

BACKGROUNDS

A background is the life a character lived before the campaign began — the work they did, the people they knew, the masters who taught them. Each background adds two item slots, raises one of two linked statistics, and unlocks specific specializations.

Backgrounds can be repeated to deepen them — a character with two levels of *Trader* has spent twice as long at the trader's bench, has wider contacts, and has unlocked deeper specialisations within the trade.

Each background's contacts vary by place of origin. A *Watch* who grew up in Cliffside Hold knows different people than one from Scarlet Vale. The DM keeps the contact list.



NOBLE (CHAR · MIGHT)

Items: horse, armor, sword

Specializations: Parry, Swords



FARMER (ENDU · HAND)

Items: flail, donkey, sling, dog

Specializations: Sling, Druid



SCHOLAR (WILL · PERC)

Items: staff, backpack

Specializations: Healer, Jeweler, Navigation, Magic



WATCH (PERC · MIGHT)

Items: glave, breastplate, crossbow

Specializations: Blocking, Pole weapon, Crossbow



CRAFTER (HAND · WILL)

Items: tools, backpack

Specializations: Woodworking, Cloth, Leather, Smithing, Machinist, Cooking, Axes, Religion



MONASTERY (ENDU · WILL)

Items: staff

Specializations: Blocking, Blunt, Religion, Monk



ASCETIC (WILL · CHAR)

Items: staff

Specializations: Druid, Shamanic, Religion, Magic



TRADER (CHAR · HAND)

Items: cart, donkey

Specializations: Jeweler, Navigation



FISHER (ENDU · PERC)

Items: fishing net

Specializations: Woodworking, Cloth, Brawl, Religion



CIRCUS TROUPE (SPEED · DEX)

Items: whip

Specializations: Climbing, Juggle



BACK ALLEY (HAND · DEX)

Items: dagger, darts

Specializations: Climbing, Sneak, Darts, Scouting



HUNTER (MIGHT · DEX)

Items: bow, falcon, dog

Specializations: Climbing, Axes, Cooking, Bows, Scouting, Tracking, Druid



MINER (ENDU · MIGHT)

Items: pickaxe, leather

Specializations: Axes, Brawl



ARMY (MIGHT · ENDU)

Items: spear, shield, leather

Specializations: Shield, Brawl, Spear

SPECIALIZATIONS

A specialization is a trained skill — taught by a master, sharpened through repetition, useful in specific tests. Each specialization is governed by one statistic, and adds its level to relevant actions.

You can only take a specialization if a background you have unlocks it. The background represents the world you trained in; the specialization is what you trained at.

A specialization's level cannot exceed the combined level of supporting backgrounds. Two levels of *Crafter* support *Smithing 2*, but only *Smithing 1* if you have one level of *Crafter*.

DEXTERITY

Shield, Parry, Blocking, Sneak, Juggle, Climbing

HANDINESS

Woodworking, Cloth, Leather, Smithing, Healer, Machinist, Jeweler, Cooking

MIGHT

Axes, Blunt, Brawl, Pole weapon, Spear, Swords

PERCEPTION

Bows, Crossbow, Sling, Darts, Scouting, Tracking, Navigation

WILLPOWER

Religion, Shamanic, Magic, Druid, Monk

ITEMS

Items are unlocked by backgrounds (each background lists what it can equip), with twelve basic supplies any character can take once. Some items grant a card; some carry the character's load.

Bulk — every item has a bulk value. Carrying capacity is **Endurance × 3**. A character whose total bulk exceeds capacity is *encumbered* — slower on the road, no Speed-class actions in close quarters, and audible movement that breaks Stealth.

Negative bulk — mounts and the backpack carry weight *for* the character. A donkey at −9, a horse at −6, a cart at −20, a backpack at −3 — these add to the capacity budget.

Basic supplies are unrestricted: any character can take *knife, food, clothes, leather repair, tent, bedroll, rope, waterskin, lantern, writing kit, instrument, oil flask*. Each can be taken once.

Item	Bulk	Notes
horse	-6	Speed · Endu · <i>travel</i>
armor	3	Might · Char · <i>imposing</i>
sword	2	Might · Dex · <i>parry</i>
flail	4	Might · Endu · <i>stun</i>
donkey	-9	Endu · Will · <i>stubborn</i>
sling	0	Perc · Dex · <i>stun</i>
dog	0	Perc · Char · <i>tracking</i>
staff	3	Dex · Speed · <i>block</i>
backpack	-3	Endu · Speed · <i>carry</i>
glave	5	Might · Endu · <i>stop</i>
breastplate	2	Might · Will · <i>defend</i>
crossbow	4	Perc · Hand · <i>wound</i>
tools	1	Hand · Will · <i>craft</i>
cart	-20	Endu · Hand · <i>steady</i>
fishing net	2	Perc · Will · <i>restrict</i>
whip	2	Dex · Will · <i>steer</i>
dagger	0	Perc · Hand · <i>sneaking</i>
darts	0	Will · Perc · <i>poison</i>
bow	2	Perc · Endu · <i>cripple</i>
falcon	0	Char · Perc · <i>search</i>
pickaxe	3	Endu · Will · <i>breaching</i>
leather	2	Speed · Dex · <i>armor</i>
spear	3	Might · Speed · <i>intercept</i>
shield	2	Dex · Endu · <i>block</i>
knife	0	Dex · Hand · <i>cut</i> · mostly for cooking · <i>basic</i>
food	1	for 3 days · <i>basic</i>

clothes	1	an extra set · <i>basic</i>
leather repair	1	will be used up · <i>basic</i>
tent	2	per person · <i>basic</i>
bedroll	1	<i>basic</i>
rope	1	climb, tie, drag · <i>basic</i>
waterskin	1	a day's water on the road · <i>basic</i>
lantern	1	with oil for one long evening · <i>basic</i>
writing kit	0	parchment, quill, sealing wax · <i>basic</i>
instrument	1	a small stringed or wind piece · <i>basic</i>
oil flask	0	refills lanterns; flammable · <i>basic</i>

EXAMPLE CHARACTER — NADINE

A complete sheet, assembled from the rules in the preceding sections — and a face you will actually meet in play. Nadine runs the trader's circuit through Elmsfield; the character on this page is the same character your DM will bring through the Inn one evening, calling Bridget by name and dropping a market rumour from Scarlet Vale. Read this as a worked example of how every part fits together; remember it the night her cart pulls up.



NADINE

Female · Finches · Raft city

Nadine left her family's counting house at the river port for the navigator-schools at fledgling age, spent four years on a curriculum of unchanging roads and never-twice-the-same weather, and returned to her merchant group as the navigator who could also talk. She runs the southern circuit now — Raft city to Linar, Linar to Salmonswell, the inland stops on the trade road — paying her room early, tipping fairly, and singing with the room when the room asks.

CHAR	DEX	ENDU	HAND	MIGHT	PERC	SPEED	WILL
3	1	1	2	1	3	2	1
Inspire	Action	Resist	Trick	Battle	Spot	Move	Focus

XP spent: 0

BACKGROUNDS

Trader 2

SPECIALIZATIONS

Navigation 1

POWERS

Flight 1 (flying) · Hearing 1 (information) · Musical 1 (atmosphere)

PROGRESSION

#	TYPE	NAME	LEVEL	STAT	XP
1	background	Trader	1	Char	0
2	power	Musical	1	Char	0
3	specialization	Navigation	1	Perc	0
4	power	Hearing	1	Perc	0
5	background	Trader	2	Hand	0
6	power	Flight	1	Speed	0

EQUIPMENT

donkey, cart, knife, clothes, tent, bedroll, food

bulk -24 / 3

MENTORS

Navigation — the Raft City navigator-schools — four years as a fledgling on a curriculum of unchanging roads and never-twice-the-same weather, taught in rotation by half a dozen senior navigators of her group rather than by a single master.

THE CARD SYSTEM

Moros is resolved with a shared deck of cards rather than dice. Every player draws from the same pile, every turn; the cards a character contributes shape what the table can do this scene.

Draw two, commit one. Each round, every player draws two cards from the shuffled stack and commits one as their action. The committed card is spent. The other is held for next round.

Statistics on the card. Each card shows two statistics. If the action being attempted is one the character has trained for — a stat shown on the card matches a stat or specialization the character has — the character adds that stat's value to the total.

Tension. Every scenario starts with a tension value. Aid passed between players, complications in the scene, and reinforcements raise it. When tension breaks past five, the scene itself becomes hostile — every committed card may carry a complication.

Aid each other. A player can pass a card to another player during their own turn. The receiver must play that card on their next turn. Aiding raises tension by one but lets the table cover for a struggling member.

Heroic action. A player may, once per scenario, commit *both* cards drawn for a single action. The total is the sum of both cards' contributions — but the cards are spent, the round is theirs, and tension rises by two.

CARD TYPES

Base cards — twelve permanent cards, one per element (Flame, Water, Wind, Plants, Iron, Earth, Light, Dark, and four more). Always in the deck.

Character cards — added by the powers, backgrounds, and items each character has learned. Contributed at the start of each scenario as the table's *stakes*.

Scenario cards — three per scenario, shuffled in at the start and removed at the end. Each scenario type has its own.

Discovery cards — earned when a character uncovers a significant secret. Permanent, personal to that character, joins their pool.

Artifact cards — earned when a character recovers a story-significant object. Travels with the holder while they carry it; can be transferred or lost.

THE TWELVE ELEMENTS

These are the base cards always present in the deck. Each is a thread in the world's working — fire, water, iron, shadow.



FLAME

Might · Dex

fire



WATER

Dex · Speed

water



WIND

Char · Speed

air



PLANTS

Hand · Char

wood



IRON

Might · Will

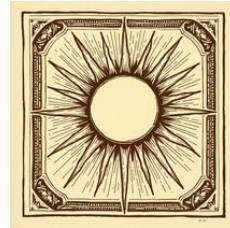
iron



EARTH

Endu · Hand

stone



LIGHT

Perc · Will

light



DARK

Perc · Endu

dark

SCENARIO TYPES

A scenario is the type of situation the table faces. Tension behaves differently in each; the cards drawn read differently in each. The DM names the scenario type at the start of every scene.

Scenarios are not exclusive — a travel scene can shift to combat; a market visit can become a negotiation. The rules of the dominant scenario apply.

The full rules for each scenario, including the challenges that arise and the powers most relevant to them, are kept by the DM. What follows is the player-facing summary.

Combat. The group is trying to gain the upper hand in a struggle. Cards passed for aid raise tension fast; coordination is the difference between a clean fight and a chaotic one.

Stealth. Moving past a watching enemy, slipping through a guard line, escaping unseen. Speed and Dex stretch; loud actions break the scene.

Negotiation. Talking through a problem the table cannot fight through. Charisma and Will lead; tension rises with every false note.

Exploration. Working through unfamiliar terrain — caves, ruins, unmapped country. Perception and Hand do the heavy lifting.

Travel. Crossing distance — road, river, hill, desert. Endurance and Speed pace the table; weather and encounters arrive without warning.

Camp. Resting properly. Watch is set; the group can recover stat damage and clear Overwhelmed states. Camp is also where stories are told.

Market. Trading at a town's market or a merchant's house. Charisma and Hand lead; word travels fast in a market.

Forage. Living off the land — finding food, water, shelter. Perception and Endurance lead; what the land offers depends on weather and season.

Repair. Fixing what has broken — gear, machines, structures. Hand and Will lead; specific tools change what is possible.

Cure. Treating injury or illness. Hand and Will lead; the *Healer* specialization changes what can be done in time.

PROGRESSION — EARNING XP AND ADVANCING

The first six progression steps cost nothing — they are the character at the start of the game. Past that, every advancement costs XP, and XP comes from earning cards.

1 XP per card earned, shared by the table. Each player character gains 1 XP when the party gains a card. The cards themselves are the visible record of what the campaign has accomplished.

Three card types count toward XP: **discovery cards**, **NPC reference cards**, **place reference cards**, and **artifact cards**. Base, character, and scenario cards do not — they are derived from progression or from the scenario itself.

Cards reward engagement, not exposure. Visiting a place or meeting an NPC does not by itself grant the card. The card's *earned by* condition has to be met.

A card is awarded only once. An object recovered as an artifact and an object understood as a discovery are different acts and each pays once; the same act does not pay twice.

XP COSTS

Past the first six progressions, each progression's XP cost is the square of the level reached. Mastery is generous early and steep at the peaks.

Level 1 (within first 6 progressions): 0 XP

Level 1 (past the first 6): 1 XP

Level 2: 4 XP

Level 3: 9 XP

Level 4: 16 XP

Level 5: 25 XP

STAT AND SPECIALIZATION ACTIONS

Every statistic and every specialization grants its character specific actions — named ways the stat or skill expresses in play. These are listed against the linked stat's action register.

An action's prerequisite (where it has one) is in the form *Stat* $\geq$ *N*. Once the prerequisite is met, the action is available; using it costs that round's commit if it would not otherwise.

The DM resolves any ambiguity about whether an action applies.

ACTION

feint *Dex* $\geq$ 3 — Swap the played card with another from your hand after the opponent has committed their reaction.

flourish *Dex* $\geq$ 4 — Expend your card to force the enemy to waste their next action on you instead of another player.

AXES

hew — Cut through a shield, door, or object as part of an attack without a separate action.

overhead smash — Drive the opponent prone; they must spend their next action standing or fight from the ground (–2 to attacks).

BATTLE

power through *Might* $\geq$ 3 — Add Might to the total even when the card played has no Might symbol.

cleave *Might* $\geq$ 5 — The attack applies to every enemy in reach; each target beyond the first reduces the total by 2.

BLOCKING

counter-brace — A successful block sends the attacker off-balance; their next roll is reduced by your Dex.

BLUNT

stagger — A successful hit also pushes the target one step away; they cannot close the distance this round.

shatter — Destroy a held shield or item on a hit instead of dealing normal damage.

BOWS

pinning shot — The arrow pins clothing or gear to a surface; the target is immobilised until they spend an action pulling free.

volley — Loose three arrows at once; split your Perc total across up to three separate targets.

BRAWL

grapple — Pin the target; they cannot move or use two-handed weapons until they beat your Might on their turn.

headbutt — Stun the target for one round; they draw only one card next turn instead of two.

CLIMBING

high ground — While elevated, add Dex to any ranged or dropped attack.

rappel — Descend or swing across a gap instantly, arriving ready to act this same turn.

CLOTH

bind wound — Halt ongoing bleeding or poison by wrapping it tightly; stops deterioration immediately.

snare — Throw torn fabric to entangle a target; they lose their next movement action.

COOKING

fortifying meal — Prepare a quick meal; every player who eats draws one extra card at the start of the next round.

tainted dish — Introduce a mild toxin into food; the target suffers -2 to all rolls next round (no damage).

CROSSBOW

bolt to the gap — Ignore armor on the next attack; only natural Endurance applies to resistance.

covering fire — Keep an area suppressed; any enemy entering that zone this round loses 2 from their total.

DARTS

sleep dart — A coated dart renders the target unconscious rather than dead if they have fewer Endu points than your Perc.

rapid throw — Throw two darts in one action, each hitting a different target; split your total evenly.

DRUID

call of the wild — Summon nearby animals to create a distraction; enemies must spend a round dealing with them.

entangle — Cause roots and vines to erupt underfoot; all enemies in the zone are slowed (-2 Speed) for two rounds.

FOCUS

steel the mind *Will* ≥ 3 — Negate a fear, charm, or confusion effect on yourself or an adjacent ally.

lock on *Will* ≥ 4 — Choose one target; all your cards count as having that target's weakness for the rest of the scene.

HEALER

field surgery — Restore an ally's ability to act despite a severe injury; they return next round at half effectiveness.

stabilize — Prevent a dying ally from getting worse; they are stable until the scene ends.

INSPIRE

rallying cry *Char* ≥ 5 — Every ally recalls one card from their discard into their hand. Tension rises by 1.

strategy *Char* ≥ 3 — All players may put another card on the pile. For every Char > 3 , remove a card.

boost *Char* ≥ 4 — Players can play two cards in their next round instead of the normal one.

JEWELER

appraise — Instantly know the exact worth and origin of any object, opening new trade or negotiation options.

conceal — Hide a small item inside jewellery or clothing so thoroughly it escapes all but a dedicated search.

JUGGLE

catch — Snatch any hurled object from mid-air — weapons, stones, or arrows meant for allies.

toss item — Loft any item to any visible ally without spending an action.

LEATHER

patch armor — Restore one point of protection to any worn armor in the field mid-scene.

padding — Lash together improvised padding; the wearer reduces the next blunt blow by your Hand score.

MACHINIST

sabotage — Disable a mechanical device, siege engine, or lock in one action without leaving obvious evidence.

rig — Set up a triggered mechanism (tripwire, drop weight, spring trap) that fires automatically later.

MAGIC

counterspell — Cancel any elemental or magical effect targeting you or an ally; costs your card play for this round.

elemental surge — Amplify a card's special element; the effect covers the entire scene instead of a single target.

MONK

iron body — For one round your body counts as armor; reduce any incoming damage by your Will before Endu applies.

pressure point — Strike a precise nerve cluster; the target loses use of one limb (their choice) until they rest.

MOVE

dodge *Reaction, Speed > Dex* — Step aside from an incoming blow — one step is all it takes.

sprint *Speed >= 3* — Move to any position in the scene without spending an action, once per round.

blur *Speed >= 5* — Attack and immediately retreat before the enemy can react; they may not counter-attack this turn.

NAVIGATION

shortcut — Reduce travel time by one segment; arrive before complications tied to that segment can occur.

dead reckoning — Navigate perfectly without landmarks, stars, or maps in any terrain or weather.

PARRY

riposte *Reaction, Dex > Might* — Turn defense into offense: strike back with the parrying card itself; it always counts as Might 0.

bind — Lock the enemy's weapon in place; they must spend their next action freeing it or fight unarmed.

POLE WEAPON

keep at bay — Prevent any enemy from moving into melee range this round; they must overcome your Might to advance.

sweep — Trip every enemy in a line; they are all knocked prone.

RELIGION

sanctuary — Declare a location sacred; no violence may occur within it while you concentrate (costs one card per round).

blessing — Bestow a blessing on one ally; they may reroll any single card result once before the scene ends.

RESIST

dig in *Endu >= 3* — Ignore the next source of damage or complication entirely. Cannot be used two rounds in a row.

second wind *Endu >= 4* — Discard your hand and draw three fresh cards; any Endu shown on them may be added to your next action.

SCOUTING

lay of the land — Reveal the full layout of the scene to all players; hidden routes or exits become known.

early warning — The party is never surprised; you always act first in the first round of any encounter.

SHAMANIC

spirit ward — Raise a ward that blocks one supernatural or magical effect completely; the ward then dissolves.

commune — Ask a local spirit one question; the answer is always truthful but may be cryptic.

SHIELD

shield wall — Extend your defense to an adjacent ally; both of you resist the next attack together, combining Endu totals.

SLING

stunning stone — A carefully chosen stone dazes the target; they act last next round regardless of Speed.

ricochet — Bounce a stone off a hard surface to strike a target behind cover as if they were exposed.

SMITHING

reforge edge — Spend a turn sharpening a weapon; it gains +1 to all attack totals for the rest of the scene.

weld shut — Permanently fuse a lock, hinge, or mechanism with available metal; requires a forge or fire.

SNEAK

vanish — After acting, immediately become undetected again if no enemy is adjacent to you.

ambush — When attacking from concealment, play two cards and take the higher total.

SPEAR

brace — Set the spear; the next charging enemy takes double damage and is stopped in their tracks.

hurl — Throw the spear at range with full Might instead of reducing to Perc; retrieve it next turn as a free action.

SPOT

called shot *Perc* ≥ 4 — Declare a specific effect before rolling (disarm, trip, blind); success delivers that effect on top of normal damage.

weak point *Perc* $>$ *Dex* + *Might* — Expose a gap in the enemy's defenses; an ally may play a second card on their very next attack against this target.

SWORDS

disarming slash — A precise cut sends the enemy's weapon skidding away; acts as disarm but can be performed even if *Hand* $<$ *Dex* + *Might*.

lunge — Strike a target one step beyond normal melee range; *Dex* is added to the attack total.

TRACKING

read the trail — Determine exact numbers, direction, and time elapsed from tracks; ask the GM two specific questions.

predict path — Correctly guess where a fleeing target will be; you may intercept them without a chase.

TRICK

disarm *Hand* $>$ *Dex* + *Might* — Send the enemy's weapon flying — they can retrieve it in a turn.

improvise tool *Hand* ≥ 4 — Create a temporary item from nearby scraps; it acts as a matching item for one scene then is used up.

WOODWORKING

splint — Fashion a brace on the spot; the target ignores a limb-based penalty for the rest of the scene.

barricade — Rapidly reinforce a door, gate, or passage; it takes 3 successes to break through.

GLOSSARY

Quick reference for terms used in this manual.

Background. A life history taken at character creation or through XP. Adds a stat, item slots, and unlocks specializations.

Bulk. An item's weight-on-the-back. Total bulk is compared against carrying capacity (Endurance × 3).

Cadence. The rule that a background or specialization may not be taken twice in a row. A power must separate them.

Card. Either a play-deck card (drawn each round) or an earned card (NPC, place, discovery, artifact) that grants 1 XP and may join the player's pool.

Commit. To play a drawn card as your action this round. Spent.

Discovery card. A unique card a character earns by uncovering a significant secret. Permanent, personal.

Encumbered. Total bulk exceeds carrying capacity. Slower travel, no Speed-class close-quarters actions, audible movement.

Mastery. How many times a power has been learned. Mastery 2 unlocks deeper effects on that power.

Overwhelmed. A state where a power slips from the player's control. The DM directs the effect; the state clears after a full turn without using that power.

Power. A racial ability. Each race has seven; you can only ever learn from your own race's list.

Progression. A single step on the character sheet — a background, power, or specialization. The first six are free; later ones cost XP.

Specialization. A trained skill. Requires an unlocking background; level cannot exceed the combined level of supporting backgrounds.

Tension. A scenario's running pressure value. Rises with aid, complications, and reinforcements; past 5 the scene itself becomes hostile.

XP. Experience points, earned at 1 per card the party earns. Used to pay for advancement past the first six free progressions.